

Founders

- Femi Aluko is the co-founder and CEO of Chowdeck and was formerly a Principal Engineer at Paystack, which was acquired by Stripe in 2020. ([source](https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck) (<https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck>))
- Olumide Ojo is the co-founder and CTO of Chowdeck and spent five years working in African fintech companies, most recently as Principal Engineer at Paystack. ([source](https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck) (<https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck>))
- Lanre Yusuf is the co-founder and COO of Chowdeck and was formerly an Engineering Lead at Crown Interactive where he led software engineers developing business support solutions for a power utility company in Nigeria. ([source](https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck) (<https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck>))
- At Paystack, Femi Aluko was responsible for building the core payment infrastructure for multiple payment methods as the fifth engineer and first Core Payments Engineer in 2017. ([source](https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck) (<https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck>))

Company

- Chowdeck was founded in October 2021 and is based in Lagos, Nigeria. ([source](https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck) (<https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck>))
- Chowdeck is a Series A company that has raised \$18.4M in total funding across 3 rounds. ([source](https://tracxn.com/d/companies/chowdeck/_YmRWVoQ-PgZrb-QC3oXgg53_zuos3NBII8jHIKWgATg) (https://tracxn.com/d/companies/chowdeck/_YmRWVoQ-PgZrb-QC3oXgg53_zuos3NBII8jHIKWgATg))
- Chowdeck's latest funding round was a Series A on July 9, 2025, with participation from 7 investors. ([source](https://tracxn.com/d/companies/chowdeck/_YmRWVoQ-PgZrb-QC3oXgg53_zuos3NBII8jHIKWgATg) (https://tracxn.com/d/companies/chowdeck/_YmRWVoQ-PgZrb-QC3oXgg53_zuos3NBII8jHIKWgATg))
- Chowdeck raised \$2.5 million in seed funding in May 2024, led by Y Combinator and Goodwater Capital. ([source](https://launchbaseafrica.com/2024/04/30/chowdeck-secures-2-5-million-seed-funding-to-expand-food-delivery-operations-in-nigeria/) (<https://launchbaseafrica.com/2024/04/30/chowdeck-secures-2-5-million-seed-funding-to-expand-food-delivery-operations-in-nigeria/>))
- As of July 2024, Chowdeck had 7 employees. ([source](https://tracxn.com/d/companies/chowdeck/_YmRWVoQ-PgZrb-QC3oXgg53_zuos3NBII8jHIKWgATg) (https://tracxn.com/d/companies/chowdeck/_YmRWVoQ-PgZrb-QC3oXgg53_zuos3NBII8jHIKWgATg))
- Chowdeck is on a mission to empower restaurants in Africa to deliver meals to customers anywhere and anytime. ([source](https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck) (<https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck>))

- Chowdeck has expanded to eight cities in Nigeria: Lagos, Abuja, Ibadan, Port-Harcourt, Ilorin, Benin City, Abeokuta and Asaba. ([source \(https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/\)](https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/))

Market

- More than half of consumer spending in Nigeria is directed towards food and grocery, with 59% of monthly spend on food. ([source \(https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/\)](https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/))
- Nigeria's online food delivery market is projected to grow at an annual rate of 15% resulting in a market volume of \$5.7 billion by 2029. ([source \(https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/\)](https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/))
- Despite the prevalence of incumbents in Nigerian food delivery, user penetration is below 15%. ([source \(https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/\)](https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/))
- Chowdeck ranks 1st amongst 35 active competitors, of which 3 are funded. ([source \(https://tracxn.com/d/companies/chowdeck/_YmRWVoQ-PgZrb-QC3oXgg53_zuos3NBII8jHIKWgATg\)](https://tracxn.com/d/companies/chowdeck/_YmRWVoQ-PgZrb-QC3oXgg53_zuos3NBII8jHIKWgATg))
- Chowdeck's top competitors include FoodCourt, HeyFood and Mealed. ([source \(https://tracxn.com/d/companies/chowdeck/_YmRWVoQ-PgZrb-QC3oXgg53_zuos3NBII8jHIKWgATg\)](https://tracxn.com/d/companies/chowdeck/_YmRWVoQ-PgZrb-QC3oXgg53_zuos3NBII8jHIKWgATg))

Product

- Chowdeck is an app-based platform offering food delivery services that allows users to order food from nearby local restaurants, with its mobile app available for Android and iOS users. ([source \(https://tracxn.com/d/companies/chowdeck/_YmRWVoQ-PgZrb-QC3oXgg53_zuos3NBII8jHIKWgATg\)](https://tracxn.com/d/companies/chowdeck/_YmRWVoQ-PgZrb-QC3oXgg53_zuos3NBII8jHIKWgATg))
- Customers can buy food in a few short steps and have it delivered to their doorstep in under 30 minutes. ([source \(https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck\)](https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck))
- Chowdeck has delivered over 80,000 meals in the last six months in two major cities in Lagos. ([source \(https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck\)](https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/chowdeck))
- Chowdeck processes more than 14,000 deliveries daily through a network of 6,000 riders for their 500,000 users. ([source \(https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/\)](https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/))
- Chowdeck boasts a delivery window of 22 to 30 minutes. ([source \(https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/\)](https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/))
- Aside from food, Chowdeck started delivering groceries and medications last year. ([source \(https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/\)](https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/))

Risk Flags

- One of Chowdeck's biggest challenges is hiring riders as fast as the orders are growing, with the company moving from processing 4000 orders to 10,000 within two weeks. ([source \(https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/\)](https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/))
- Expanding logistics infrastructure requires capital, and operating across multiple verticals from food to retail to merchant software introduces significant operational complexity. ([source \(https://techpoint.africa/guide/chowdeck-retail-logistics/\)](https://techpoint.africa/guide/chowdeck-retail-logistics/))
- Global competitors with deeper funding could accelerate their own retail strategies in response to Chowdeck's expansion. ([source \(https://techpoint.africa/guide/chowdeck-retail-logistics/\)](https://techpoint.africa/guide/chowdeck-retail-logistics/))

Suggested Questions

- What specific strategies is Chowdeck using to recruit and retain riders at the pace needed to match order growth? ([source \(https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/\)](https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/))
- How does Chowdeck plan to maintain profitability while paying riders competitive wages that exceed Nigeria's minimum wage by three to five times? ([source \(https://launchbaseafrica.com/2024/04/30/chowdeck-secures-2-5-million-seed-funding-to-expand-food-delivery-operations-in-nigeria/\)](https://launchbaseafrica.com/2024/04/30/chowdeck-secures-2-5-million-seed-funding-to-expand-food-delivery-operations-in-nigeria/))
- What is the company's plan for expanding beyond the eight current Nigerian cities, and what data drives city selection decisions? ([source \(https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/\)](https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/))
- How does Chowdeck's unit economics compare to previous failed entrants in the Nigerian food delivery market like Jumia Food and Bolt Food? ([source \(https://launchbaseafrica.com/2024/04/30/chowdeck-secures-2-5-million-seed-funding-to-expand-food-delivery-operations-in-nigeria/\)](https://launchbaseafrica.com/2024/04/30/chowdeck-secures-2-5-million-seed-funding-to-expand-food-delivery-operations-in-nigeria/))
- What percentage of current revenue comes from the new grocery and pharmacy verticals versus the core food delivery business? ([source \(https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/\)](https://thecondia.com/chowdeck-raises-seed-funding-femi-aluko-2/))

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